
AI Tools to Build Apps Today.

No-code to pro level. Twenty-six tools, seven stacks, twenty-eight ideas, and a path for wherever you are starting.

NO-CODE · EDITORS · BACKEND · APIS · AUTOMATION · AGENTS · DESIGN

FOR

Beginners, developers, founders and students

INSIDE

Builders, editors, backends, APIs, automation, agents, design

COST TO START

Zero

START HERE

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How to use this directory

Skim the quick-reference table in section 03 and pick the category that matches what you are trying to make. Read that section's cards in full. Then jump to the stack combinations in section 11 to see which tools actually fit together, and to the ideas in section 12 for something concrete to build this weekend. Every tool listed here has a free tier — you can work through the entire guide without paying for anything.

THE SHIFT

02 Why Now

Two years ago, building an app meant learning to code, hiring a team, or handing a freelancer several lakh rupees. Today the distance between an idea and a working app is measured in hours, and most of the toolchain is free.

That change is not marketing. Bolt.new, Cursor and v0 proved that people who do not write code can ship production-grade software, and that people who do write code can move several times faster. A single well-written paragraph now generates a working application. Work that took three months takes three days.

What has not changed is the hard part. Tools do not tell you which problem is worth solving, who has it, or whether they will pay to have it removed. The tools have collapsed the cost of building; the cost of choosing well is exactly what it always was. Treat this directory as the map, not the destination — the value comes from shipping something small into real hands and finding out what happens.

26

tools, all with real free tiers

7

proven stack combinations

28

app ideas with existing demand

3

learning paths by starting point

The rule that matters most

Shipped beats perfect. Launch the version with one feature, put it in front of real users, and let their reaction decide what you build next. Your first app will not be good — it is not supposed to be. The people who wait for good never ship at all.

QUICK REFERENCE

03 Every Tool at a Glance

The whole directory on one page: what each tool is for, and what you get without paying. Detailed cards follow in sections 04 to 10.

TOOL	CATEGORY	WHAT YOU BUILD	FREE PLAN
Bolt.new	No-code builder	Full-stack web apps	Free (limited)
v0 by Vercel	No-code builder	React UI components	Free tier
Lovable	No-code builder	Full web apps	Free tier
Replit Agent	No-code builder	Web + backend apps	Free tier
Cursor	AI code editor	Any app, with AI assist	Free (hobby)
Windsurf	AI code editor	Multi-file agentic edits	Free tier
GitHub Copilot	AI code editor	Any code project	\$10/mo
Supabase	Backend / DB	Auth + database + APIs	Free (500 MB)
Firebase	Backend / DB	Mobile + web backend	Free (Spark)
Railway	Hosting	Any backend app	\$5 trial credit
Vercel	Hosting	Frontend + serverless	Free tier
OpenAI API	AI / LLM	Chat, analyse, generate	\$5 free credit
Anthropic API	AI / LLM	Complex reasoning tasks	Free credits
Gemini API	AI / LLM	Multimodal AI features	Generous free tier
Replicate	AI models	Image / video / audio AI	Pay-per-use
ElevenLabs	AI voice	Text-to-speech, cloning	Free 10K chars
Make.com	Automation	Visual no-code workflows	Free (1,000 ops)
n8n	Automation	Self-hosted workflows	Free (open source)
Zapier	Automation	App integrations	Free (5 Zaps)
Relevance AI	AI agents	No-code AI agents	Free tier
Flowise	AI agents	Visual LangChain agents	Free (open source)
LangChain	AI framework	Custom AI pipelines	Free (open source)
CrewAI	AI framework	Multi-agent teams	Free (open source)
Figma	UI / design	UI prototypes and design	Free (3 projects)
Framer	UI / design	Marketing websites	Free tier
Webflow	UI / design	No-code websites + CMS	Free (staging)

Pricing moves quickly in this category. Treat every figure here as a starting point and confirm on the tool's own pricing page before you commit to anything.

ZERO TO APP IN HOURS

04 No-Code AI App Builders

These tools are built for non-developers. Describe what you want and the AI builds it — coding optional.

B Bolt.new

Full-stack apps from a single prompt

NO-CODE AI BUILDER

BUILD	Full-stack web apps — React frontend, Node backend and a database. Complete working apps from one text prompt, deployed instantly.
BEST FOR	Beginners who want a complete app fast. Entrepreneurs validating ideas. Anyone who can describe what they want in plain English.
FREE	Free tier with limited daily tokens · \$20/mo unlimited
LINK	bolt.new

v0 by Vercel

Describe a UI, get production-ready React

AI UI COMPONENT GENERATOR

BUILD	React and Next.js components and full page layouts. Describe the interface you want and get clean, Tailwind-styled code instantly.
BEST FOR	Developers who want beautiful UI without designing from scratch. Dashboards, landing pages, forms.
FREE	Free tier, 200 credits/month · \$20/mo
LINK	v0.dev

L Lovable

Build and ship full web apps with AI

NO-CODE FULL-STACK BUILDER

BUILD	Complete web applications — authentication, database, UI and backend logic all integrated. GitHub sync and one-click deploy to production.
BEST FOR	Founders building SaaS MVPs. Product managers prototyping. Non-technical people shipping real products.
FREE	Free tier, 5 projects · \$20/mo
LINK	lovable.dev

R

Replit Agent

Code, run and deploy apps in your browser

BROWSER IDE + DEPLOYMENT

BUILD	Any web app, script, bot or backend service. Runs instantly in the browser with no local setup. AI autocomplete plus an agent that builds features.
BEST FOR	Students learning to code. Quick prototypes. Apps that need to run 24/7 without you managing servers.
FREE	Free tier with limited compute · from \$7/mo
LINK	replit.com

Which builder, when?

Bolt.new when you want a complete app from nothing, fast — it builds everything. **v0** when you already have a project and need the interface to look good. **Lovable** for SaaS products that need auth, a database and real backend logic from day one. **Replit** when you are learning, or when the app has to run continuously without you touching a server.

SUPERCHARGE YOUR DEVELOPMENT

05 AI Code Editors

If you already write some code, or want to learn, these editors multiply your speed. The AI suggests, writes and debugs alongside you.

C

Cursor

The AI-first code editor — VS Code, but smarter

AI CODE EDITOR

BUILD	Any app in any language. The AI understands your entire codebase, writes functions, fixes bugs and explains unfamiliar code.
BEST FOR	Developers at every level. The most complete AI coding experience — tab to complete whole functions, chat with your repo.
FREE	Free tier, 2,000 completions/month · \$20/mo
LINK	cursor.com

W

Windsurf

An agentic editor that acts, not just suggests

AGENTIC AI CODE EDITOR

BUILD	Full apps with multi-file edits. The Cascade agent plans and executes complex tasks across your whole project, not just one file at a time.
BEST FOR	Developers who want AI to take over multi-step work. Strong on large refactors. A capable VS Code alternative.
FREE	Generous free tier · \$15/mo
LINK	codeium.com/windsurf

GH

GitHub Copilot

AI pair programmer inside VS Code

AI CODE COMPLETION

BUILD	Any project in VS Code. Line-by-line and whole-function suggestions across 20+ languages, plus Copilot Chat for questions about your code.
BEST FOR	Developers already living in VS Code. Best for incremental work and eliminating boilerplate rather than starting from zero.
FREE	Free for students and open source · \$10/mo
LINK	github.com/features/copilot

THE ENGINE ROOM

06 Backend, Database & Hosting

Once the frontend exists you need to store data, manage users and ship the thing. Every tool here starts free.

S

Supabase

Open-source Firebase alternative on Postgres

BACKEND-AS-A-SERVICE

BUILD	User authentication, a PostgreSQL database, file storage, realtime subscriptions and edge functions — a complete backend for web or mobile.
BEST FOR	Most apps: SaaS, marketplaces, social apps, dashboards. The safest default for beginners.
FREE	Free: 500 MB database, 50K monthly active users, 1 GB storage
LINK	supabase.com

F

Firebase

Google's realtime app platform

BACKEND-AS-A-SERVICE

BUILD	Realtime database, authentication via Google, phone or email, cloud functions, hosting and push notifications.
BEST FOR	Mobile apps in React Native or Flutter. Realtime features like chat and live updates. Deep Google ecosystem integration.
FREE	Free (Spark): 1 GB database, 50K auth/month, 10 GB hosting
LINK	firebase.google.com

Rw

Railway

Deploy any backend in seconds

CLOUD HOSTING & DEPLOYMENT

BUILD	Deploy Node.js, Python, Go or anything else. Managed PostgreSQL, MySQL and Redis. One-click deploys from GitHub with auto-scaling.
BEST FOR	Developers who want fast deployment without AWS complexity. The strongest Heroku replacement.
FREE	\$5 trial credit · pay-per-use from about \$5/mo
LINK	railway.app

Vc**Vercel**

Frontend hosting plus serverless functions

FRONTEND HOSTING + SERVERLESS

BUILD	Next.js, React and Vue apps deployed instantly. Serverless API routes, edge functions and automatic preview deploys on every pull request.
BEST FOR	Any frontend project, and Next.js above all. Best-in-class developer experience for the web.
FREE	Free: unlimited personal projects, 100 GB bandwidth/month
LINK	vercel.com

THE INTELLIGENCE LAYER

07 AI APIs

These APIs add the actual intelligence — chat, analysis, images, voice. All pay-per-use, and all free to test.

OA

OpenAI API

The broadest AI API — GPT-4o, DALL·E, Whisper

LLM + IMAGE + AUDIO API

BUILD	Chatbots, text analysis, code generation, image creation with DALL·E 3, speech-to-text with Whisper and text-to-speech.
BEST FOR	Almost any AI feature. The widest model selection, the best documentation and the largest developer community.
FREE	\$5 free credit on new accounts · GPT-4o about \$0.005 / 1K tokens
LINK	platform.openai.com

An

Anthropic Claude API

Best for complex reasoning and long documents

LLM API FOR ANALYSIS

BUILD	Multi-step reasoning, document analysis, coding and long-form writing. A 200K-token context window swallows entire codebases or books at once.
BEST FOR	Document processing, legal and compliance apps, careful multi-step reasoning where output quality matters.
FREE	Free credits on new accounts · Haiku is very cheap, Opus is premium
LINK	anthropic.com/api

Gm

Google Gemini API

Multimodal AI — text, image, audio, video

MULTIMODAL LLM API

BUILD	Text generation, image understanding, code and audio processing. Gemini 1.5 Pro carries a one-million-token context window.
BEST FOR	Anything that needs to understand images. Google ecosystem work. The most generous free tier for experimenting.
FREE	Gemini Flash free up to 15 requests/minute
LINK	ai.google.dev

Rp

Replicate

Run any open-source AI model through one API

AI MODEL MARKETPLACE

BUILD	Image generation with Stable Diffusion or Flux, video, audio, text and code models — thousands of them behind a single API.
BEST FOR	Image and video features. Any time you need open models without managing GPU infrastructure yourself.
FREE	Pay per prediction, roughly \$0.001–\$0.05 per run
LINK	replicate.com

EI

ElevenLabs API

The most realistic text-to-speech available

VOICE AI API

BUILD	Text-to-speech in 29 languages, voice cloning and long-form narration. Adds a believable voice to any product.
BEST FOR	Podcast and audiobook tools, accessibility features, multilingual voice products.
FREE	Free: 10,000 characters/month (~10 minutes) · from \$5/mo
LINK	elevenlabs.io

MODEL	ROUGH COST	USE IT FOR
Gemini Flash	Free up to rate limits	Prototyping and high volume
Claude Haiku	About \$0.25 per 1,000 messages	Cheap production workloads
GPT-3.5 Turbo	About \$0.20 per 1,000 messages	Simple classification, drafts
GPT-4o	About \$5 per 1,000 messages	When output quality decides the product

Spend nothing while you are still guessing

Start on Gemini Flash or Claude Haiku while you work out what the feature should even do. Only move to GPT-4o or Claude Sonnet once you can point at a specific place where the cheaper model's answers are costing you users. Most projects never need to make the switch.

SYSTEMS WITHOUT CODE

08 Automation & No-Code Workflows

Use these when you want to connect apps and services without writing code. Ideal for business tools, lead-gen systems and content pipelines.

Mk Make.com

The most capable visual automation platform

NO-CODE AUTOMATION

BUILD	Multi-step workflows across 1,500+ apps, with HTTP requests, data transformation, AI steps and scheduling built in.
BEST FOR	Business automations, lead-gen pipelines, content workflows and CRM integrations. The best all-round automation tool.
FREE	Free: 1,000 operations/month, unlimited scenarios · \$9/mo for 10K
LINK	make.com

n8 n8n

Open-source automation — self-host or cloud

OPEN-SOURCE AUTOMATION

BUILD	Everything Make does, open source. Self-host free forever, with built-in AI nodes, code nodes for custom logic and 350+ integrations.
BEST FOR	Developers who want full control, and any team where data privacy rules out a hosted platform.
FREE	Self-hosted: free · Cloud from \$20/mo
LINK	n8n.io

Zp Zapier

The easiest automation — 6,000+ integrations

NO-CODE AUTOMATION

BUILD	Simple two-step automations (Zaps) across the widest app library anywhere, with ChatGPT integration built in.
BEST FOR	Absolute beginners. Straightforward if-this-then-that workflows. Whenever the app you need is only supported by Zapier.
FREE	Free: 5 Zaps, 100 tasks/month · \$20/mo
LINK	zapier.com

BUILD THINKING SYSTEMS

09 AI Agent Builders

Agents plan, decide and act on their own. This is the next layer above a simple AI feature.

RI Relevance AI

No-code AI agent builder

NO-CODE AGENT PLATFORM

BUILD	AI agents with tools, memory and workflows — research agents, support bots, lead-gen agents — assembled in a visual drag-and-drop builder.
BEST FOR	Non-developers who want genuinely capable agents. The best starting point for business automation with reasoning.
FREE	Free tier with limited runs · \$19/mo
LINK	relevanceai.com

FI Flowise

Open-source visual LangChain builder

VISUAL AGENT & CHATBOT BUILDER

BUILD	LLM chains, chatbots, retrieval-augmented generation apps and agent workflows, all through a drag-and-drop interface over LangChain.
BEST FOR	Developers who want LangChain without writing it. RAG chatbots over your own documents.
FREE	Free and open source — self-host on Railway in five minutes
LINK	flowiseai.com

Lc LangChain

Python and JS framework for LLM apps

AI APPLICATION FRAMEWORK

BUILD	Complex AI pipelines — RAG systems, multi-agent apps, memory-enabled chatbots and tool-using models. The industry-standard framework.
BEST FOR	Developers comfortable in Python or JS who want full control over production-grade AI systems.
FREE	Free and open source — you pay only for the model APIs you call
LINK	python.langchain.com

Cw

CrewAI

Multi-agent AI teams in Python

MULTI-AGENT FRAMEWORK

BUILD	Teams of agents with distinct roles working together — a researcher, a writer and an editor collaborating on one task.
BEST FOR	Complex jobs that benefit from specialists. Content pipelines and research workflows.
FREE	Free and open source · CrewAI+ cloud from \$29/mo
LINK	crewai.com

MAKE IT BEAUTIFUL

10 UI & Design Tools

Once the code works, design decides whether anyone stays. These make professional interfaces reachable without a design degree.

Fg

Figma

The industry standard for UI and UX design

DESIGN & PROTOTYPING

BUILD	Wireframes, UI mockups, interactive prototypes and design systems, with Dev Mode for clean handoff to code.
BEST FOR	Anyone designing an app before building it. Collaborative design, investor decks and user-testing prototypes.
FREE	Free: 3 projects, unlimited personal files · \$15/mo
LINK	figma.com

Fr

Framer

No-code websites with real interactions

WEBSITE BUILDER + CMS

BUILD	Marketing sites, landing pages and portfolios with smooth animation, a CMS for content and AI copywriting built in.
BEST FOR	Startups that need a beautiful marketing site. Designers who want motion without writing code.
FREE	Free staging preview · \$10/mo to publish on a custom domain
LINK	framer.com

Wf

Webflow

Professional no-code web builder

WEBSITE & CMS BUILDER

BUILD	Complex marketing sites, e-commerce and membership sites with pixel-level control, a real CMS and SEO tooling.
BEST FOR	Agencies and freelancers building client sites. Content-heavy and SEO-focused projects.
FREE	Free: 2 staging projects · \$14/mo to publish
LINK	webflow.com

WHAT FITS WITH WHAT

11 Stack Combinations

Tools are chosen in groups, not one at a time. These combinations are in production across thousands of small projects, and each one starts free.

APP TYPE	FRONTEND	BACKEND / DB	AI LAYER	DEPLOY
SaaS web app	Bolt.new / Lovable	Supabase	OpenAI API	Railway / Vercel
Mobile app	Cursor + React Native	Firebase	Gemini API	Expo EAS
AI chatbot	v0	Supabase	OpenAI / Claude	Vercel
Automation tool	Make.com	Airtable	OpenAI API	Make.com
AI agent app	Flowise / Relevance	Pinecone (vector)	LangChain	Railway
Landing page / blog	Framer / Webflow	Static	Optional	Framer / Vercel
Internal tool	Retool / Appsmith	PostgreSQL	OpenAI API	Railway
E-commerce	Bolt.new + Stripe	Supabase	Gemini API	Vercel + Stripe

The beginner's stack

If this is your first app, stop comparing and use this: **Bolt.new** for the app itself, **Supabase** for the database and login, **Gemini** for the AI feature, **Vercel** to put it online. Total cost for your first thousand users: nothing. Swap pieces out later, once you have a reason to.

IDEAS WITH DEMAND

12 28 Things You Could Build

None of these are novel, which is the point — people already want them and already pay for worse versions. Each is a weekend MVP with the tools in this directory.

Built in a day

[Bolt.new](#) or [Lovable](#)

- 01 AI resume builder — paste a job description, get a tailored resume
- 02 Invoice generator with PDF export for freelancers
- 03 Expense tracker with category breakdowns
- 04 Study flashcard generator — paste notes, get cards
- 05 Social caption generator for Instagram and LinkedIn
- 06 Wedding budget planner with vendor tracking
- 07 Local business directory for your city
- 08 Event RSVP manager with email notifications

AI-powered apps

[OpenAI](#) or [Gemini API](#) + [Supabase](#)

- 09 Message tone analyser — is this coming across the way you meant?
- 10 Email reply generator — paste what you got, get three replies
- 11 Recipe suggester based on what is in your fridge
- 12 Contract simplifier — upload a contract, get plain English
- 13 Interview question generator for any job role
- 14 Blog outline generator with SEO keywords
- 15 Review sentiment analyser for e-commerce listings
- 16 Hindi-to-English professional email translator

Automation apps

[Make.com](#) + [AI APIs](#)

- 17 Lead scoring bot — form submission scored by AI, pushed to CRM and Slack
- 18 Content repurposing pipeline — one blog post into five posts
- 19 Daily news digest emailer, curated by topic and summarised
- 20 Competitor price monitor with change alerts
- 21 YouTube-to-blog converter — transcript into a formatted article
- 22 Job application tracker with automatic follow-up reminders

Agent apps

Relevance AI, Flowise or LangChain

-
- 23 Research agent — company name in, competitive intelligence report out
 - 24 Personal finance agent — bank statement in, spending analysis out
 - 25 Code review agent — pull request in, detailed feedback out
 - 26 Support agent trained on your product docs, answering 24/7
 - 27 Meeting notes agent — recording in, action items and invites out
 - 28 Property research agent — location in, price trends and amenities out

THREE STARTING POINTS

13 Pick Your Path

Same destination, three routes in. Find the one that matches where you are today and follow it literally — the sequencing matters more than the individual tools.

Path A — Complete beginner

No coding experience

DAY 1-3	Describe an app in Bolt.new and build it
DAY 4-7	Follow a Supabase tutorial; add a database to that app
WEEK 2	Build your first automation workflow in Make.com
WEEK 3	Deploy your first no-code AI agent in Relevance AI
MONTH 2	Add an AI feature using the Gemini free tier

GOAL Working, deployed app with an AI feature by the end of month two

Path B — Some coding knowledge

You can read code and follow docs

DAY 1-2	Install Cursor; start a new project or open an old one
DAY 3-5	Integrate Supabase auth and database from the docs
WEEK 2	Build your first AI chat feature on the OpenAI quickstart
WEEK 3	Build a RAG chatbot over your own documents in Flowise
MONTH 2	Work through LangChain; build a custom agent with tools

GOAL Production-grade AI app deployed on Railway or Vercel

Path C — Working developer

You ship code already — now add AI

DAY 1	Install Cursor or Windsurf — immediate productivity gain
DAY 2-3	Add a reasoning feature with the Anthropic Claude API
WEEK 2	Build a RAG system on LangChain, Supabase and pgvector
WEEK 3	Design a multi-agent workflow in CrewAI
MONTH 2	Ship the full product: auth, Stripe payments, AI, deploy

GOAL A monetisable AI product live within two months

NO MORE WAITING

14 Start Today

Everything in this document assumes you have exactly two things: an idea, however vague, and thirty minutes. That is genuinely the whole requirement. The tools are free, the documentation is good, and the communities around them answer questions from beginners without making it weird.

A year from now the only thing you will regret is not having started now. So do the smallest possible version of it today.

01 Open Bolt.new

Type your idea in, even if it is half-formed. Watch what gets built in the next two minutes.

02 Create a free Supabase account

Five minutes now means you have a database and a login system ready tomorrow.

03 Choose one idea from section 12

Pick the one you would personally use. Start building it tonight, not next week.

The best app is the one you actually build and ship.